

Joyce Meyer

HOW DOES FAITH WORK?

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Title: How Does Faith Works

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Foreword

Faith is not merely a doctrine to be studied; it is the living heartbeat of every believer's walk with God. In *How Does Faith Work*, Joyce Meyer opens the Scriptures with her unmistakable clarity and boldness, guiding readers into a practical, Spirit-empowered understanding of biblical faith. Her teaching carries the weight of experience—shaped through trials, obedience, and a lifetime of trusting God in both the seen and unseen.

What strikes me most about this message is its simplicity without dilution. Joyce dismantles confusion surrounding faith and brings the reader back to what Scripture has always taught: **Faith believes before it sees, speaks what God has said, acts upon His Word, and is energised by love.**

This book invites you into that journey. It challenges you to deal with unforgiveness, to align your confession with God's promises, and to anchor your hope in His unchanging nature—even when circumstances shake. Joyce's transparency about her own life gives this teaching a depth that reaches beyond theory; it becomes a living testimony of God's transforming grace.

As you read, I encourage you to pause, reflect, and allow the Holy Spirit to personalise these truths. Faith is not a formula; it is a relationship. And every page of this message calls you deeper into that relationship with Christ.

May this book strengthen your confidence in God, ignite fresh hope, and stir up the boldness to believe His Word again—fully, joyfully, and without hesitation.

Welcome to a life where faith truly works.

Wisdom Epsi

— *Chief Editor, LivingSermons.com*

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How Does Faith Work

By

Joyce Meyer

Preface

This message is a foundational teaching on faith — what it is, how it works, and how believers can release it in their daily lives. The preacher unfolds the Scriptures with clarity, testimony, and spiritual authority, pointing believers to the life Jesus paid for through His blood. Every sentence has been carefully proofread and formatted while preserving Joyce Meyer’s original voice, tone, emphasis, and flow.

Chapter One

Knowing What Is Yours

It is so important to study the Word, because it is full of what is yours — what has been bought and paid for by the blood of Jesus Christ.

What Is Faith and How Does It Work?

Faith is the foundational doctrine of the Bible. Without faith, we cannot please God. We are to live by faith. Romans 14 says that “*whatsoever is not of faith is sin.*” Faith — believing and trusting — is how we receive everything God wants us to have.

I have not taught on faith, just a good, basic, foundational, powerful message on faith, in a long time. For a long time there was a lot of teaching about faith, and I learned through that how much faith I did not have — or at least how much of it I was not putting in the right place.

Every person has faith, whether they are a believer or not. If you had no faith at all, you would not get on a highway and attempt to drive to work because you would be petrified that you would be killed. Romans says, “*God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.*” I do believe every person has faith — but the point is: **What do they do with it?**

Do you put faith in yourself? In your friends? Some today put their faith in the government, believing it to be the answer to every problem. But we can choose to put our faith in God — and when we do, amazing things begin to happen.

According to Ephesians 2:8–9, “*For by grace are ye saved through faith.*” Every blessing comes to us by the grace and mercy of God. God has provided everything through Jesus.

Faith is not the price that buys the blessings of God — it is the **hand that reaches out and receives them.**

The same way we are saved is the same way we are meant to live every day: *by faith*. Every situation that comes up requires us to act in faith.

Why Many Christians Lack Understanding

Many Christians do not really know what faith is, how it works, or how to release it.

I was born again at nine years old. After I married Dave — a strong Christian man — we went to church regularly. I loved God. Had I died, I would have gone to heaven. I had released my faith for salvation, but I had **no idea** about all the other promises in the Word of God that were available to me — already bought and paid for with the blood of Christ.

I was not benefiting from any of them because:

1. I did not know about them, and
2. I did not know I could release my faith for those things.

Many think God will simply give them whatever He wants them to have. But the Bible says, *“Ye have not, because ye ask not... ask, and ye shall receive; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.”*

There is so much available that people never tap into.

The Promises of God

I recently read that there are **5,467 promises** recorded in the Bible. That means every single one of us is missing some of them.

I will not go through all 5,467 today, but I do want to stir you up. You may be living far below the level Jesus intended. There is probably a much better life for you — but you do not know how to access it.

You have faith, but perhaps you are not releasing it, or you do not know how.

Faith Must Be Based on God’s Word

You cannot put faith in something if you do not know God promised it. That is why we must study the Word — it is full of what is yours, bought and paid for by Christ.

We must not approach the Bible like a daily obligation meant to earn us a star on some heavenly chart. We must **devour** it. We must remind ourselves daily of what God has done for us.

Even if you do not study for yourself, do it for Jesus — because of all He suffered for you. Decide that you are going to have the life Jesus died to give you. You are not going to live a low-level, know-nothing, do-without, miserable life, attending church but seeing no change.

Faith says: *“Jesus provided it. I am His child. He loves me. I am going to trust Him for it, and I will not give up until I see what He promised come to pass in my life.”*

We All Need to Be Refreshed

Sometimes people become lazy about faith. They underline everything in their Bible, but if it is not working in their lives, they still need more teaching.

I received a fresh excitement and enthusiasm as I studied this message again. No matter how much we think we know, we need to be reminded.

Many do not know how faith works. Many live at a low level because they do not release their faith. Some have simply become lazy. “I go to church.” But where is your joy? Where is your breakthrough?

Maybe nothing is happening because you are not pressing in. The Bible says we must *“fight the good fight of faith.”* Faith sometimes involves a fight. We cannot live by what we feel — we must live by the Word of God.

If you refuse to give up, your breakthrough will come.

Standing in Faith Through Trials

I had back surgery recently — micro-surgery — and in the last three years have had both hips replaced. I have had a lot of pain and have done a lot of praying. I have been waiting and standing in faith to see the fullness of what God promises.

I am not going to give up.

Nothing upsets the enemy more than when you say, “I don’t care how long it takes.”

Stop thinking that disadvantages mean God cannot use you. Stop looking at what you cannot do. Do what you **can** do, and do it by faith.

If you do the little bit you can do, God will do what you cannot.

Faith Comes by Hearing

Romans 10:17 says, *“Faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”*

As the Word is preached, your faith rises. Many believe only two promises:

1. “I am saved,” and
2. “Someday I will go to heaven.”

But that is not the extent of our Christian experience. We are the head and not the tail, above and not beneath. We are anointed. We have authority over the devil.

God Will Never Leave You

God promises never to leave us nor forsake us. I went to church for years and did not know that. I thought God was somewhere off in the sky. I did not know He lived in me by the Holy Spirit.

How can you ever be alone if God lives in you?

Your relationship with God should be the focus of your life. You can talk to Him anywhere, any time, about anything. And He cares.

My life was radically transformed when I learned these things.

Christ in Us

One morning, while combing my hair, I said to the Lord, “I always feel like I am reaching for You and can never quite find You.” I did not know about hearing from God, but in my spirit I heard: *“While you are reaching out, you should be reaching in.”*

Christ in me — the hope of glory. He lives in us. We are His home, and He is ours.

You may live alone, but you are not alone. You may not be married, but you are not alone. Your children may not call, but you are not alone. God is with you all the time.

God Is With Us Everywhere

Joshua 1:9 says, “*Be strong and of a good courage... for the Lord thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.*”

He does not live in the church; He lives in you. If you go to the grocery store, Jesus goes with you. If you drive in traffic, He is with you.

Proverbs 15:3 says, “*The eyes of the Lord are in every place, beholding the evil and the good.*” There is nowhere you go that God does not see you.

Even grocery-store moments can be holy moments when you live with the awareness of God’s presence.

Jesus did not die so we could have a brand of religion. He died so we could have an intimate relationship with God.

So here’s the thing: if you are doing good and nobody seems to notice, nobody seems to applaud, and nobody seems to care—God sees. He knows every single thing you are doing. He knows every moment of suffering you’ve endured. He sees every injustice and every sacrifice, and He keeps His eyes on the evil too. He knows exactly who is mistreating you, who is ignoring what they should be doing for you, and who is taking advantage of you. And the wonderful thing is this: **God is a God of justice**, and in His perfect time, He will deal with the evil and He will reward the good.

God promises to be our *Vindicator*. And not only that—He promises to give us **double for our former troubles** when we trust Him and stop trying to fight our own battles.

If someone has hurt you and you insist on getting back at them, you are stepping into God’s territory. But if you will forgive, if you will trust God to handle it, He will turn everything around in ways you could never orchestrate. I can boldly tell you that if I had not forgiven my father, trusted God to be my Vindicator, and handed over all those wrongs to Him, I would not be standing here today. The rewards God has prepared for you will absolutely leave you astonished. But you must retire from self-care—stop trying to ensure everyone treats you right—and let God be the One who lifts you up.

Anything God intends for you to have, **no person on earth can keep from you**, as long as your eyes remain on Him.

The God Who Settles All Cases

“Vengeance is mine; I will repay, saith the Lord.” — Hebrews 10:30

God says that full justice rests with Him. He will repay. He will exact compensation. He will judge, determine, solve, and settle the cause and the cases of His people.

Turn to someone and say, *“God is on your case.”*

But let’s rewind for a second. You cannot take only the promises you like and leave the rest. You say, “I’m trusting God to vindicate me.” Wonderful. But Scripture also says that if you pray and ask God for something, you will receive **only if you have forgiven anyone who has offended you**. We love the verse about God paying back our enemies. We don’t love the part about needing to forgive first.

And let me say something you may not enjoy hearing, but it is truth: **You cannot feel sorry for yourself and still walk in God’s good plan for your life.**

You may have a reason to feel sorry for yourself, but you do not have the *right*, because God is offering you complete freedom.

Jesus Receives Every Person Who Comes to Him

One of the most beautiful promises in Scripture is that Jesus never rejects anyone who comes to Him. Never. It doesn’t matter how far you think you have fallen or how badly you believe you have failed. If you go to Him sincerely and humbly say, “Lord, forgive me, help me,” He will never turn you away.

That is good news. When you’ve messed up, you don’t need to run *from* God—you run *to* Him, because He is always waiting with open arms.

All Things Work Together for Good

The Bible assures us that God, being a Partner in our labour, causes **all things to work together for good** for those who love Him and desire His will.

How He does this, I cannot explain. It is beyond human understanding. But I can testify that God took the horrible things in my life—the abuse, the brokenness, the disadvantages—and somehow turned them into spiritual strength, compassion, and purpose. I am, unbelievably, a better person because of what happened to me, not in spite of it.

Your history does not have to be your destiny.

God says:

“I know the thoughts and plans that I have for you... to give you hope and a good final outcome.”

You may not be there yet, but you are on your way.

Faith Must Be Released

This is an exciting message because it reminds us: God loves you, and He has a good plan for you. But it is not automatic. You must release your faith. Faith is a force—it is spiritual power residing in your spirit—but it must come out through words, prayer, and action.

Consider Israel’s deliverance. Leaving Egypt is a picture of salvation—a free gift. The Red Sea parted before they did anything. Moses stretched out his rod and the waters split. That is salvation: Jesus did it all; we only believe.

But entering the Promised Land was different. When they reached the Jordan River, it did not part until the priests put their feet in the water. Salvation is free. **The promises of God require steps of faith.**

Many Christians have left Egypt but are still wandering in the wilderness. They have never stepped into the Jordan to enter God’s promises—provision, peace, healing, joy, destiny, purpose.

Some of you have dreams in your heart—big dreams, God-ordained dreams—but fear has kept you from even taking the first step. You cannot keep saying, “Well, if God wants it for me, He’ll drop it into my lap.” No, He won’t. You must step out.

When God put it in my heart to start a Bible study, I didn’t know the Bible and I didn’t know how to teach. But I had to say “yes”, invite people, and take the risk of rejection. I had to step into the water before the water parted.

Faith always begins with a step.

Faith in Giving and God's Kingdom Economy

Giving is another area where God calls us to step out in faith. If you don't have enough money, keeping everything you have will never produce an increase. God says:

"Prove Me now... and see if I will not open the windows of heaven and pour out a blessing you cannot contain." — **Malachi**

It is a step of faith. He says: "Try it."

Prosperity, Favour, and Promotion

Prosperity is not a dirty word. The religious spirit hates it, but Scripture does not. God does not want His people living as beggars. He wants you supplied so you can meet your needs and bless others. But hear this clearly: **God only wants you to have it if He can remain first in your life.**

The danger with abundance is pride. Jesus spoke of the camel and the needle's eye. But the "needle's eye" was a small gate in Jerusalem. A camel could get through, but only by kneeling and being unloaded. The more you have, **the more you must stay on your knees.**

Staying Humble and Walking Right Before God

One of the greatest mistakes we can ever make is to begin mistreating others once God starts lifting us. That is why you must go through life on your knees, staying humble before Him. Everything you have is a gift, and every bit of influence you hold is a gift. And just as quickly as He gave it, He can remove it far faster than it took you to receive it.

People say the strangest things about ministers. If you search my name online, one of the labels people attach to me is "prosperity preacher". Labels are irritating, because most people who use them don't even know what they mean. But let's have a moment of honesty: would you truly prefer that I stand here and tell you God wants you broke, empty and at the back of the line? You are His child. Just as I longed for my own children to have everything good I could give them, God longs for you to walk in His provision — **but only when your soul is mature enough to handle it.**

"Beloved, I wish above all things that thou mayest prosper and be in health, even as thy soul prospereth" (3 John 1:2 KJV). Your growth is His priority; possessions come afterwards.

Chapter Two

Growing Into the Blessings God Has Prepared

When Dave and I first wrote instructions for our estate, we had a young child at the time. Did we give him free access to everything? No. He had to grow first. Likewise, God wants you to have every good thing He planned for you — but you must grow, mature and develop the character to handle it.

I once spoke with a woman who had been a Christian for thirty years. She worked retail and was struggling to meet her sales quota. When I asked whether she had prayed for God's favour, she said, "Well, that wouldn't be right, would it?"

No one had ever taught her that she could ask God for favour! For years I didn't know either. Now I ask for favour daily. Do you think I walked onto this platform today without asking God to give me favour with you? I cannot force anyone to like me — but God can touch hearts.

Stop playing political games to win acceptance. Stop chasing people to earn approval. If you have to buy friendship, you will have to keep paying to maintain it. Ask God for divine connections instead. Whoever He wants in your life, He will draw them to you.

How We Release Faith

Faith is released in three primary ways:

1. **Praying**
2. **Saying**
3. **Doing**

Faith begins with asking God according to His Word. “Faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen” (Hebrews 11:1 KJV). When you ask in faith, the answer may not appear immediately, but you must hold your ground and believe God.

Next, align your words with what you’ve prayed. Do not pray for your children’s salvation and then spend the afternoon declaring they’ll never be saved. Do not pray for financial breakthrough and then say, “We’ll never get out of debt.” Many people pray in faith but speak in unbelief — and their own confession breaks down what they prayed.

Finally, **do something**. Faith without action is dead. You cannot pray for employment without applying for a job. You cannot pray for ministry without taking steps toward it. You cannot pray for change without acting when God prompts you.

Taking Steps of Faith — Even When They Make No Sense

When I first felt God calling me to teach a Bible study, nothing made sense. I didn’t know the Bible well. I didn’t know how to teach. I didn’t think anyone would come. But God said, “I do.” So I obeyed.

First I invited people. To my surprise, they came — and they kept coming. Later, persecution came and we had to move the meeting to our home. We took another step of faith, and attendance doubled.

For five years I taught that study. Then God told me to stop. For a whole year, nothing happened — a season of waiting. But faith keeps moving when God leads, and keeps waiting when God pauses.

Then came the next step: serving in a church. Teaching women only wasn’t my dream — I wanted to teach everyone. But God said, “This is what’s before you. Do it.” So I did, and the doors widened. I was asked to teach when the pastor travelled. Then I served as associate pastor. I taught in Bible college. Every step was preparation for the next. After five years the Lord said, “Quit your job and go north, south, east and west.”

Nobody knew me in any of those directions — but I obeyed. God does not always speak in ways that are reasonable to the natural mind, but His Spirit witnesses within us with persistent, holy desire.

If you are sensing something from God that will not leave your heart, ask Him for a clear confirmation, especially with major decisions. Then take one step. If it works, take another.

Soon, those tiny steps become strides — and eventually you are running with God into things you never imagined.

Being Faithful in Small Beginnings

All of this started forty-two years ago. I have now been away from my original church for about thirty-two years, and nobody knew me — not north, south, east or west. I was on one radio station in St. Louis. So off I went: North St. Louis, East St. Louis, South St. Louis and West St. Louis.

We began holding one little monthly meeting in each direction of our city. We would have twenty people come... fifteen people come... one time I did a meeting with nine people — and I had taken five of them with me! I did not start in arenas and on television. You must be faithful in small things, and then God will make you ruler over much.

Some of you need more finances. Perhaps the next step isn't merely praying for more — perhaps it's stepping out to do something God has been nudging you to do. Maybe you will even need to give more before you will see more. But many people do not want to hear that.

“If I had more money, I would give more.”

Well, I do not want to be insulting, but if you will not give from what you have now, you will not give when you get more. You start by giving when it hurts a little — when it doesn't make much sense — and you do not give once just to “see what happens”. You become committed. You stay faithful. You let the devil know:

“I will do this until my last breath — not to get something, but because I believe it is the Word of God.”

Finishing Your Race With Strength

Here we are today, forty-two years later. And I'll tell you something my children do not like to hear — but I'm going to say it anyway. I would love to preach a message, sit down, and go to heaven. That is how I want to leave — preaching. Teaching the Word.

They say, “Mother, can you imagine how horrible that would be for the people in the meeting?”

Just remember this: if you happen to be there the day it happens, that is exactly what I wanted, so do not be upset.

The point is this: I intend to do what God has given me to do as long as I have breath. I have told Him many, many times, “Whatever energy I have left until I die, You are getting it.”

You will never be happier than when you are right in the centre of God’s will. Not all of you are called to preach or teach. Maybe your vision is to lose ten pounds or tidy your closet — that’s fine too. The principle is the same: you start somewhere, you go through somewhere, before you get somewhere.

We must be the kind of people who do not quit and do not give up.

Review: How We Release Our Faith

How do we release our faith?

Praying. Saying. Doing.

Let’s practise that: how do we release our faith?

You take action. You pray. You line your words up with what you believe.

Romans 10:8–10 speaks of salvation — how we receive it.

“...The word is nigh thee, even in thy mouth, and in thy heart...

That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised Him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.” (Romans 10:8–10 KJV)

You believe in your heart, and you confess with your mouth.

Verse 10 continues: “For with the heart man believeth unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.”

When I believe in my heart, God knows it. When I open my mouth, that lets the devil — and everybody else — know where I stand.

Do not try to be a sneaky Christian. If you will not take a stand in a meeting full of believers, you will not stand out in the world. The disciples told people immediately. So should we. Do not be obnoxious at work — but do not hide your faith either.

Faith is first in your heart — and then it must get in your mouth.

Walking by Faith, Not by Sight

“For we walk by faith, not by sight.” (2 Corinthians 5:7 KJV)

Faith is not something you have because you saw something convincing. It isn't even something you have because you felt something convincing. It starts in your heart. Often you will believe something that makes no sense to your natural mind.

Anybody here today believe God wants to do something in your life — and you can back it up with the Word — but it makes no sense to your mind?

Anybody believing for something that looks impossible?

Well, if you're not believing for the impossible, you're not in the realm where miracles happen. The only way you receive a miracle is if you need one — when you stop depending on everything else and trust God alone.

Launching Out a Little Deeper

In Luke 5:1–5, we read about Jesus teaching by the lake. The people pressed in to hear Him. Two boats were nearby, and the fishermen were washing their nets after a long, unproductive night. Jesus stepped into Peter's boat and asked him to push out a little from the shore. Speaking over water carried His voice farther.

After Jesus finished preaching, He said to Peter, “Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught.”

Peter replied, “Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing...”

Some of you have been “fishing” half your life and caught nothing yet — maybe because you have not gone deep enough. You are tired. You want to go home. But Jesus is saying, “*Try again. One more time.*”

Maybe it is time to pick up an old dream, dust it off and believe again. Maybe you have a child you are about to give up on.

Don't Quit on Your Children

My son David — you have seen him in our world missions ads — nearly drove me to my grave. He was rebellious, strong-willed, and always wanted what he wanted when he wanted it. If I cooked chicken, he wanted spaghetti. If I cooked spaghetti, he wanted chicken.

I felt like he came out of the playpen trying to figure out how to run the world.

At one point I felt led to offer him a job. Many times afterwards I wondered, “What was I thinking?” He was so hard to work with.

One morning, driving to work, I said, “That’s it. I’m going to fire him.”

And God spoke clearly — one of the few times I can say I know I heard Him: **“Joyce, do not give up on David.”**

That boy now runs our entire world missions programme.

Faith Works With Patience

“Let us run with patience the race that is set before us.” (Hebrews 12:1 KJV)

Patience is waiting, enduring, going through — not quitting — **and keeping the right attitude while you wait**. You stay calm. You keep a good confession. You keep believing God will do exactly what He said.

If you cannot hold on to something very long, you will struggle with the faith walk. Many — perhaps most — answers from God take time.

Hebrews 6:11–12 tells us to imitate those who “through faith and patience inherit the promises.”

There are 5,467 promises in the Word of God. You inherit them by believing, praying, saying, and patiently doing every little thing God asks of you.

Do not expect instant results. If they come, wonderful. If they do not, you are already prepared to hang on and not give up.

Unlimited Refills of the Word

If something is wrong physically, you go to a doctor, receive a prescription, and get two or three refills. You do not expect one spoonful to fix everything. You take the medicine, wait, take the medicine, wait, and if you see a bit of improvement, you keep going.

Well, with the Word of God, you get **unlimited refills**. You just keep going back, and back, and back.

Faith works by patience. Faith is full of expectation. Faith must be released — you pray, you say, you do.

Trials Produce Patience — Eventually

James 1:2–3 says:

“My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations; Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.”

I have found that trials worked a lot of things out of me **before** we got around to patience!

Faith Works Through Love

Another vital lesson about faith is this: **faith works, functions, and is energised by love**. Scripture presents love in three directions, and every believer must hold all three in balance: **love for God, love for oneself, and love for people**.

Loving God

The greatest commandment is clear: “*Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind*” (Matthew 22:37–38, KJV). Yet before we can truly love God, we must first be convinced that **He loves us**.

How can you put your faith in someone whose love you are not certain of?

If you lack a solid revelation of God’s love, pause every vision, dream, and ambition. Spend the next season immersing yourself in the truth of His love. Romans 8 declares that *nothing* can separate us from His love—not pain, not difficulty, not failure, not opposition (Romans 8:38–39, KJV). Once your heart agrees with that, you are ready for the next level.

Loving Yourself

If you do not love yourself, you will struggle to believe that you deserve anything from God. A poor self-image suffocates bold faith. Many cannot ask or believe for God’s promises simply because they do not value themselves the way He does.

Loving People

And if you refuse to walk in love toward others—holding bitterness, mistreating people, remaining angry—your faith will not work.

“Faith... worketh by love.” (Galatians 5:6, KJV)

Some are praying, confessing, declaring—yet carrying unforgiveness. Scripture is plain: it will not work.

Speak to the Mountain — But Forgive First

Jesus said:

“Whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; and shall not doubt in his heart... he shall have whatsoever he saith.” (Mark 11:23, KJV)

Faith believes first and sees later. God’s Kingdom does not operate by “seeing is believing.” You believe long before anything shows up.

Then Jesus added:

“And when ye stand praying, forgive, if ye have ought against any.” (Mark 11:25, KJV)

Why is forgiveness connected to answered prayer? Because **faith only works through love**.

You cannot mistreat people behind closed doors and expect public blessings. Faith must be lived in private as much as in public. One of the greatest marks of spiritual maturity is **how quickly you forgive**. The quicker you forgive, the stronger you are spiritually.

Faith Brings Results

Faith in God always produces results. Hebrews 11 is a catalogue of ordinary people who accomplished extraordinary things simply because they believed.

- **By faith**, Abel offered a better sacrifice.
- **By faith**, Enoch was translated and never saw death.
- **By faith**, Noah built an ark when rain had never been seen.
- **By faith**, Abraham left home not knowing where he was going.
- **By faith**, Sarah conceived long after her body’s natural season.

- **By faith**, Moses refused palace comfort to serve God's people.
- **By faith**, the walls of Jericho fell.
- **By faith**, Daniel shut the mouths of lions.

These were not superhumans. They were everyday people who simply **believed God**, aligned their words with His promise, and acted on His instructions. The world remembers them because faith made them world changers.

God desires to do the same for you—things so great they will leave your mouth open in awe. He wants to bless you, prosper you, favour you, heal your heart, and work through you in remarkable ways. But you must **pray, say, and do**.

Faith must be **released**, not stored.

Chapter Three

Protecting Your Faith in an Unstable World

We live in a world of collapsing marriages, rising natural disasters, and constant criticism—but faith is kept strong the same way any relationship is kept strong: by **spending time with God**.

Prayer, Scripture meditation, worship, service—these feed faith. Surround yourself with strong believers; you become like whatever you stay around.

Feed your faith, or the world will weaken it.

We cannot depend on what we see. Faith is of the heart. Jesus said to Thomas, “*Blessed are they that have not seen, and yet have believed.*” (John 20:29, KJV)

Every day, return to the Word. Meditate. Give thanks. Remind yourself of God’s promises. This is how faith survives a shaking world.

Are Faith and Hope the Same?

Faith and hope are connected, but not identical.

Hope is the **springboard** that lifts you into faith. Hope is the positive expectation that something good is about to happen. Many try to walk in faith while holding a hopeless attitude. They are negative, discouraged, or fixated on past disappointments. Without hope, faith has no place to land.

Hope and Faith Working Together

Let me illustrate hope and faith through my own life. I was abused throughout my childhood and cannot remember anything truly good happening until my mid-twenties. By that time, I

carried a deeply negative, hopeless attitude. I loved God, went to church faithfully, and prayed what I often call “*desperation prayers*”—“*Oh God, help me, I’m in trouble.*”

But did I actually believe He would help me?

I am not sure I did. My imagination was filled with fear, always expecting something bad to happen next.

When I truly began studying **hope**, I realised that without it, genuine faith is nearly impossible. Real faith is full of hope—an expectation that something good is about to happen. People may try to operate in faith while holding a hopeless mindset, but that is not real biblical faith.

Biblical hope is not, “*Well, I hope it works out...*” Biblical hope is confident expectation grounded in God’s character.

Can You Have Faith for Someone Else?

A viewer asked whether she could have faith on behalf of her parents. To a degree, yes—but with an important distinction.

When we pray for someone, we open the door for God to work in that person’s life—convicting, guiding, redirecting, softening, or revealing truth. But God will never use our prayers to **control** someone’s decisions.

So I pray for others boldly and consistently, trusting that my intercession creates space for God to move. If people still choose wrongly, I do not conclude that my prayers were useless. We are co-labourers with God in the ministry of intercession and reconciliation.

I often wonder who prayed for me during my difficult years. My grandfather was a godly man—always in his rocking chair, reading his Bible and praying. He may well have been the one whose prayers continually opened the door for God to reach me.

When Faith Feels Shattered

Another question came from someone who prayed earnestly for something, believed God would help, and then saw the exact opposite happen. She feels her faith has been shattered. How can she trust God again?

This is delicate because I do not know whether what she prayed for was God’s will in the first place.

Scripture teaches:

- God hears our prayers.
- God answers our prayers.
- *“If ye abide in me... ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.”* (John 15:7, KJV)

But we must read all Scripture together.

James 4 tells us that we:

- Sometimes do not receive because we do not ask.
- Sometimes ask with wrong motives.
- Sometimes ask outside God’s will.
- Sometimes ask in the wrong timing.

Over the years, I have learned this:

Ask God for anything you want — but add, “Please do not give it to me if it is not Your will.”

Faith does **not** mean we get everything we ask for. Even when something *is* God’s will, timing is still in His hands.

The enemy would love for unanswered prayers to destroy our trust in God. But the Lord once whispered to my heart:

“If you do not get what you asked for, I am not withholding from you. I know something better, and you are not yet far enough along to know how to ask for it.”

Trusting God means trusting Him **in** things as much as **for** things—through the entire process, not only at the finish line.

Closing Exhortation

Walk with God. Stay in His Word. Keep your hope alive.

And never forget: **Faith must be released. Faith must be fed. Faith must work through love.**

About the Speaker

Joyce Meyer is a respected Bible teacher whose ministry has impacted millions around the world. Together with her husband, Dave Meyer, she has served in ministry for more than four decades, sharing the Gospel with clarity, boldness, and practical wisdom.

In 1987, they founded Joyce Meyer Ministries — a Christ-centred, non-profit organisation built on faith, integrity, and the support of partners who share their passion for reaching people with God's love. Through Joyce's teaching, countless believers have been encouraged to grow in their walk with God and apply His Word to everyday life.

A significant part of this vision is **Hand of Hope**, the global missions arm of the ministry. Through this outreach, Joyce Meyer Ministries reaches suffering and vulnerable communities with practical help and the message of Christ. These initiatives include feeding programmes, medical care, orphan homes, and efforts combating human trafficking.

Joyce's heart for hurting people and her commitment to sharing God's Word continue to inspire, equip, and bring hope to those in need throughout the world.

About Living Sermons

Living Sermons is a Spirit-led publishing platform dedicated to transforming timeless messages of God’s servants into books that can reach and impact lives across the world.

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